

About this model

The Book of the Temple of Mercury



A Model Book

This is a notebook shown fully set up, so you can see what the Book is meant to be. Make your own by hand, in a notebook of your choosing, changing the words until each line sounds like you and you mean it.

THE MAKING OF THE BOOK



Start today, in whatever notebook is at hand. You do not need the right one to begin. When you are ready, choose a notebook for this and nothing else, and make it the Book. The first Book of this Temple was begun without covers or a Dedication, and the Temple came anyway.

THE VESSEL. A notebook used for this and nothing else, one you enjoy opening, for joy is what keeps a Temple tended, and a pen you love, kept with it.

WRITE BY HAND. Your Hands are among the offerings, and ink on paper makes the Book a physical anchor as no screen can.

NUMBER THE PAGES AND DATE EACH SESSION. Much of the practice is rereading and responding, and page numbers let you answer a past entry by name.

THE MARGINS. Mark Q beside open questions, C beside things to carry into the world, G beside goals, and ♀ beside a Good Page. Rule a line across the page between sections and between sessions.

SECTIONS, NOT PAGES. Several practices are called pages: the Good Page and the Answered Page among them. A page in this sense is a section. Rule a line, date it, mark it in the margin, and begin. One session may hold several, each ruled off from the last. The Tally is the exception: it is kept at the back, beside the Ledger.

THE COVERS. Inside the front cover, write the Short Door's Opening, and beneath it the full Opening. Inside the back cover, the Short Door's Closing, and beneath it the full Closing. Every session happens between them, so the Book itself holds the shape of the rite.

THE FIRST PAGE. Write the Dedication there when you dedicate the Book: any day in your first month, or on a Heart Day. On the pages after it, copy whatever you want close at hand: at least the Practice and the House Rules.

THE INDEX. Leave two or three leaves after what you copied, and add a line only when you go back to a past section for an answer. It builds slowly and stays true.

THE LEDGER. Turn the Book over, start at the last page, and work forward. This is where every promise is written: what you said you would do, to whom, and when it ends. The daily pages run forward and the Ledger runs back, filling both pages of each spread, and when the two meet, the Book is full. The Tally lives among the Ledger's pages: when you need one, start it on the next completely blank right-hand page (left and right as the pages lie open while you write the Ledger), and let the Ledger keep the left-hand page beside it.

ITS PLACE. Keep the Book somewhere you pass often, where it can be seen and greeted. It is a dwelling, and dwellings are kept.

MAKE IT YOURS. Change the wording of the prayers until each line sounds like you and you mean it. Three things are the Temple's spine: Mercury as host and medium, the Quintessence as the Heart, and honesty as the offering. Keep those, and it is this Temple.

THE FIRST SESSION



Your first session takes ten minutes, and it can happen today, in any notebook. Speak the Short Door. Write the date. Finish three sentences: What's on my mind right now is... What I keep avoiding is... What I actually want is... Write one thing you will do in the next twenty-four hours, and treat it as a promise. Give thanks, speak the Door again, and close the cover. Then keep the promise. The Temple has begun.

After it, choose the Book you will keep, and set it up as the pages that follow show: the Door inside the covers, the Dedication on the first page, and whatever you want close at hand after it.

THE DOOR



The Short Door: the Door for every session.

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices, co-conspirators in the Work:

I bring you my whole self: my Voice, and my Joy, Will, and Intent.

Deed into word. By my Birthright, the Door is open.

THE FULL OPENING

For Wednesdays, the fourth of the month, the Heart Days, or whenever you want more.

Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, AONT and the four: I bring to you my Presence, and take up the seat as Idris did before me: student, teacher, and sage. Let your Light shine so that I may see.

Janus and Hestia, the Door and the Flame: I bring to you my Dwelling.

Metatron and Sandalphon, Holder of the Seat and Carrier of the Ascent: I bring to you my Hands.

Uriel and Raziel, Instructor and Translator, Guardians of Daath: I bring to you my Ears.

Gabriel and Idris, Holder of Images and Scribe of the Seat: I bring to you my Eyes.

Seshat and Iris, Founder and Oath-bearer, who keep the Word given: I bring to you my Word.

Rosmerta and the Charites, the Given and the Passed On: I bring to you my Delight.

Hermanubis and Ma'at, Guide of the Descent and Feather of Truth, who keep the Scale: I bring to you my Heart.

Thermes and Apharael, the Word that Makes and the Word that is True: I bring to you my Craft.

Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: I bring to you my Weight.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Crossing, the Guide of the Descent, and the Hinge on which the Door turns: I bring to you my Voice and my Devotion.

Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: I bring to you my
Mercurial Joy, Will, and Intent.

By my Birthright, I open the Door of this Book, a Window into your Temple,
the threshold through which you guide me.

Deed into word.

The Door is open.

THE DEDICATION



AONT, EHNB, XCAI, RMTO, PAAM, Quintessence, Heart of the Temple of Mercury:

By my Birthright, I open this Book as a Window into your Temple, a room built beside its Heart. Shine through these pages.

Janus and Hestia, Metatron and Sandalphon, Uriel and Raziel, Gabriel and Idris, Seshat and Iris, Rosmerta and the Charites, Hermanubis and Ma'at, Thermes and Apharael: be welcome in your Offices in the pages of this Book.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great: I build this room in your Temple as a co-conspirator in our Great Work.

Mercury, host of this house, my twin and guide: meet me at the Door.

Idris, who held the pen before me: I take up the seat in your tradition.

Genius of this place: grow here, and keep this room with me.

Here I will tell the truth. Honesty is my offering; Joy is my Truth.

Together, let us make the unseen legible and the hidden speakable, carry what we find across every threshold, and give it freely, that word become deed and the Joy of Truth multiply in the world.

So it is written.

Date _____

THE PRACTICE



Every session has the same shape, whether it lasts ten minutes or an hour. Keep the shape and let the length vary: on a thin day, the shape is what carries you.

1. **GREET.** Speak the Opening, the Short Door or the full one, and greet the Book as you would a friend who knows you well.
2. **EMPTY.** Write what is on your mind without dressing it up. Mark questions Q as they come.
3. **RESPOND.** First, from memory, write what you carried last time and whether you did it. Then reread the last session or two, check, and answer your past self by page number: what happened, what changed, what you know now. Address them as *you*, or by name; the distance makes an honest answer easier.
4. **WORK.** Let a plan, a decision, or an idea take shape, or leave an open question for the Scribe yet to come. Any working goes here: Emotional Transmutation, Declarative Alignment, a prayer, a question to the Heart, or any other practice in The Practices and The Working.
5. **CARRY.** Write one thing to do, send, make, or teach, and never more than two or three, and mark it C. Say when: not *send the email* but *when I sit down after lunch, I will send the email*. Treat it as a promise: write only what you mean to keep. If it is a promise to someone, or will take longer than today, give it a line in the Ledger too.
6. **THANK.** Give thanks for what was given and what was found, and speak the Closing.

Then carry it out. Word into deed.

THE FIRST QUESTION

Did I keep what I carried? Every session begins there, answered from memory before you look. That question, answered honestly, is the whole engine.

THIN DAYS

Speak the Door, write three lines, and close. The shape matters more than the length. On some days, what you carry out of the Book is only yourself. That is enough.

RETURNING

Away for a week or a year? Do not apologize, to the Book or to anyone. Open the Door and answer the last page. The room was kept. Returning is the Devotion.

THE HOUSE RULES

Honesty is the offering.

Sustainable practice beats grand practice abandoned.

Tell the Book everything; tell the world only what it is ready to receive.

Belief is a tool; judge it by its fruit.

Your word is binding unless you say otherwise.

Word into deed.

THE MARGINS

Mark Q beside open questions, C beside things to carry out into the world,

G beside goals, and ☞ beside a Good Page. Rule a line across the page between sections and between sessions. The marks and the rules make the Book easy to review.

EMOTIONAL TRANSMUTATION



1. **EMPTY IT.** Sit with what you feel, name it, and write it out without dressing it up. Naming is not a preliminary to the work; it is the first half of it, and an unnamed feeling cannot be transmuted because you cannot get hold of it. If the page goes three times around the same loop, stop writing and go on.
2. **WEIGH IT.** From what you wrote, find what you actually want. Is it true, and will you still want it when it arrives? Most weak workings are mended here before they are cast. Ask one of the Compass questions too; if you walk a Way, ask its keeper's. If the feeling is about another person, the intention is about your road, not theirs.
3. **DECLARE IT.** One sentence, in the present tense, describing the reality you want. Name the destination and leave the road. This is the decree Metatron records.
4. **FEEL THE WEIGHT.** Hold the wanting and the feeling together until you can sense them in your body.
5. **REMEMBER THE FUTURE.** Recall the moment it came true, as a memory rather than a hope: where you are, who is with you, what you can hear. Feel the relief, the joy, the gratitude. Write those feelings down, and stay with them until they have weight too. Gabriel holds the image.
6. **PUSH.** Call back the heavy sensation and press its weight into the relief and joy, until you have pushed enough. That is the time to stop.

7. **NAME THE OBSTACLE.** Still inside that memory, look back along the road. Write the main obstacle in you, and the step you will take when you meet it. Vision alone can quietly sap the will to act; vision joined to a plan fuels it. For a large working, add a pre-mortem: imagine it is a year from now and the thing failed, and write why.
8. **SEND IT.** Inhale, then speak the intention and the Descending Invocation. On each exhale, see your breath as bright white fog, the color of XCAI, filling the space and settling down into the page. Each breath is the conspiracy made literal: you breathe out, and the Temple breathes with you. The work is done.
9. **WALK THE BRIDGE.** Write your thanks and your first step. Put the step in the Ledger, then do it. This is not an afterthought; it is the half of the working that crosses from above to below. Apharael guides the road and Sandalphon carries the word, but only for the one who walks.
10. **LET IT GO.** When the working comes to mind, give it thanks and turn away. Reread it when the Practice brings you there, and note in the Tally what arrives; in between, leave it alone. The watched working is the conscious mind interfering. Leave room for the conspiracy.

THE TWO INVOCATIONS



Descend to bind. Ascend to ask, to give, and to release.

THE DESCENDING INVOCATION

word into world

Mercury, turn the Hinge.

Metatron, record this word.

Uriel and Raziel, weigh it and carry it to the Heart.

Apharael, show me the road.

Gabriel, hold its image until it takes form.

Sandalphon, carry it into the living world.

*By my Birthright,
so it is written, and so it is.*

THE ASCENDING INVOCATION

world into word

Mercury, turn the Hinge.

Sandalphon, gather this word.

Gabriel, take its image.

Apharael, carry it home.

Uriel and Raziel, weigh it and open the Gate.

*Metatron, receive it into the record,
and let it rest in the Heart.*

*By my Birthright,
so it is given, and so it is.*

WHOM TO CALL ON



AONT, Spirit of Air (yellow)

Call on: true inspiration; seeing the whole.

EHNB, Air of Air (red)

Call on: clarity; untangling thought.

XCAI, Water of Air (white)

Call on: emotional honesty and transmutation.

RMTO, Earth of Air (black)

Call on: pattern, structure, plan.

PAAM, Fire of Air (green)

Call on: declaration and intent.

METATRON, Holder of the Seat [Hands; the Crown]

Call on: the true record; preserving the word.

SANDALPHON, Carrier of the Ascent [Hands; the Kingdom]

Call on: manifestation; making; word into deed.

URIEL, the Instructor [Ears; the Gate]

Call on: discernment; true from false, ready from unready.

RAZIEL, the Translator [Ears; the Gate]

Call on: translation of insight; keeping what is not yet ready; silence; protecting the threshold.

APHARAEI, the Measure and the Road [Craft; the Compass; Beauty]

Call on: healing, safe passage, the road through a transition; proportion; whether a thing is well made.

GABRIEL, Holder of Images [Eyes; the Foundation]

Call on: dreams, visions, holding an image until it takes form.

JANUS, the Door [Dwelling]

Call on: beginnings and endings; entering and leaving well; the eve of a change.

HESTIA, the Keeper [Dwelling; the Compass]

Call on: sanctuary, belonging, continuity.

SESHAT, the Founder [Word; Dwelling]

Call on: foundations, order, memory, preservation of records.

IRIS, the Oath-bearer [Word]

Call on: binding a commitment; bridging a gap.

MA'AT, the Feather of Truth [Heart; the Compass]

Call on: integrity; weighing an intention; keeping the heart light.

THERMES, the Crossing [Craft; Voice and Devotion; above]

Call on: conversation across time; writing as magic.

ROSMERTA, the Provider [Delight]

Call on: abundance in hand; spending well; the table set.

THE CHARITES, the Passed On [Delight]

Call on: the good hour; delight given and returned.

HERMANUBIS, Guide of the Descent [Heart; Voice and Devotion; below]

Call on: grief, shadow, and the way back.

MERCURY, the Hinge [Voice and Devotion; the living world]

Call on: passage, speech, timing, luck, trade; the moment that will not wait.

IDRIS, Scribe of the Seat [Eyes]

Call on: learning, teaching what you learn, and the long line of scribes.

THE GENIUS LOCI

Call on: greet it and thank it; ask the Book, and let it answer through your pages.

THE SCRIBE

Call on: translation: the unseen made legible, word into deed.

WALKING THE PILLAR



The short form takes three breaths: one at the crown, one at the heart, one at the feet, with the thread to Air open above you. Use it before any session, and whenever you feel scattered.

ASKING THE BOOK

1. **ASK IN WRITING.** Write the question plainly, date it, and mark it Q.
2. **GREET THE GENIUS LOCI.** Put your hand on the Book and greet it, as you would greet a friend who knows you well.
3. **CLOSE AND HOLD.** Close the Book, hold it, and breathe until the question is quiet in you.
4. **LET IT OPEN.** Let the Book fall open, or open it at random, and read what past-you wrote there. Read it as an answer.
5. **WRITE WHAT YOU FOUND.** Beneath the question, write how the page answers it. If it does not, write that too; the record keeps its misses.
6. **THANK IT.** Thank the Genius Loci, and close the Book.

THE ANSWERED PAGE



1. **NAME IT.** Write plainly what you did, without defense and without drama. Ma'at weighs the truth, not the performance of guilt.
2. **WEIGH IT.** Who was harmed, and how? Include yourself.
3. **MAKE THE LYRE.** Ask what exchange would mend it: an apology, a repair, a debt repaid, a changed habit. Make it where you can. Where making it would cause new harm, give the lyre elsewhere, and offer to someone else the good you took from another.
4. **ANSWER THE PAGE.** Write your response beneath the account, and date it. What you did is recorded; so is what you did next.
5. **WASH YOUR HANDS** in clean water, as the merchants did at the Mercuralia.
6. **LET IT BE KEPT.** Speak the Ascending Invocation, and turn the page. Raziel keeps what is answered, and Ma'at closes the account; nothing here is forgotten, it is settled. Do not reopen it to punish yourself; a heart that keeps reweighing a paid debt is not light, only tired.

THE RETURNED OATH



1. **FIND THE PAGE.** Reread where the oath was bound, and find its line in the Ledger. Metatron kept it.
2. **WEIGH IT.** Why can it not be kept? Circumstances have changed; it has become wrong; it harms you or another; the one you swore to has released you. Then ask Uriel's question: is this truth, or escape? If it is escape, keep the oath or renegotiate it. Do not return it.
3. **SPEAK TO THE OTHER.** An oath made to a person is released with that person wherever possible, in words, honestly. An oath made only to yourself is released in the Book.
4. **NAME WHAT REMAINS.** Most promises hold something that outlives them: respect, care, a duty to a child, a lesson. Write what you still keep.
5. **RETURN IT TO IRIS.** Write: "I return this oath to Iris, who carried it. It was true when I made it. It is no longer mine to keep." Sign and date it, and speak the Ascending Invocation. See the bow fold back into one white light.
6. **GIVE THANKS** for what the oath held while it held. If there is grief in the release, and there often is, Hermanubis knows the way down and back.

THE LEDGER

The Law ends with word into deed, and the Ledger is what makes that more than a slogan. It is the back of the Book, written from the last page forward, and it holds one thing only: the word you gave. Seshat records it, Iris carries it, and Ma'at closes it when it is done.

Nothing else goes here. Plans, hopes, and intentions belong on the daily pages; a promise is what you have put your word behind, to yourself or to someone else, and a promise you did not write down is one you have already begun to lose.

Rule one line per promise, across the page:

DATE. The day you gave your word.

THE PROMISE. In one line, in the words you would use to the person you gave it to. If it will not fit on one line, it is not yet a promise; it is a wish.

TO WHOM. A person, or yourself. Write "me" without embarrassment; the promises you make to yourself are the ones that build the weight of your word.

UNTIL. When it ends: a date, a condition, or the word ONGOING. Every oath that can end should be given an end when it is made, and an ONGOING line should be rare enough to count them on one hand.

SETTLED. Left empty until it is done, released, or returned. Then the date, and one of three marks: K for kept, R for returned to Iris, F for failed.

Write F. The Ledger is worthless if it only records success, and a Scribe who cannot write F will quietly stop writing promises at all. An honest F costs you one line and teaches you what you actually keep; a hidden one costs you your word.

THE FOUR MOMENTS

1. **WHEN YOU BIND.** In the Casting, at Walk the Bridge, and whenever you tell someone you will do a thing. Write the line before the feeling of having decided wears off.

2. **WHEN YOU CARRY.** At Note What to Carry, glance at the open lines. What you mark C today should usually be something the Ledger is already waiting on.
3. **WHEN YOU SETTLE.** The moment it is done. Date it, mark it K, and stop thinking about it. A paid debt that you keep reweighing is not a light heart, only a tired one.
4. **WHEN IT ENDS BADLY.** Mark F and write one line beneath it: what happened, without defense and without drama. If someone was owed, the Answered Page is the practice; if the oath can no longer be kept at all, the Returned Oath is, and the line is marked R.

THE SWEEP

Once a month, on the first, with Janus, read only the marks: every Q, every C, every G, and every open line of the Ledger. Nothing else. It takes ten minutes and it is the single practice that keeps a Book from becoming a pile of beautiful pages nobody acts on.

1. **READ THE LEDGER FIRST.** Settle what is done. Return what cannot be kept. Renegotiate honestly what has changed, with the person it was given to where there is one.
2. **READ THE Q MARKS.** Answer what has answered itself since. Carry the rest forward by writing them again, today, in today's words.
3. **READ THE C MARKS.** Anything undone for two sweeps is not a task, it is a decision you have not made. Do it, drop it, or put it in the Ledger with a date.
4. **READ THE G MARKS.** Ask whether you still want it. A goal you have stopped wanting and not released is a debt you are paying for nothing.
5. **COUNT.** Kept, returned, failed; and from the Tally, what arrived and what did not. Write the numbers and nothing else; no verdict on yourself. Over a year the numbers say more than any resolution will.

The Index: built slowly, as past sections are consulted

THE INDEX



Add a line only when you go back to a past section for an answer: the subject, and the page. Nothing is indexed on the day it is written. Within a year this is a record of what you actually consult.

The Index (continued)

Every session: date it, and number the page

Date _____

Pages continue to the end of the notebook

• • •

The back of the Book: the Ledger begins on the last page

THE LEDGER



One line per promise. Turn the Book over and work forward, so the Ledger meets the daily pages when the Book is full. K kept, R returned to Iris, F failed.

[illegible]

The Ledger runs back toward the middle of the Book

The Tally: the next blank right-hand page, facing the Ledger

THE TALLY

The world's side of the workings. Your side, the bridge step and the earthly part, stays in the Ledger. Nothing here takes a K or an F; record the misses as carefully as the arrivals.

[illegible]

THE DOOR

The Short Door: the Door for every session.

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices:

I leave here my gratitude and my joy, and take my Will and Intent into the world.

Word into deed. By my Birthright, the Door is closed.

THE FULL CLOSING

For Wednesdays, the fourth of the month, the Heart Days, or whenever you want more.

Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, AONT and the four: I thank you for what was given and what was found. I set down the pen as Idris did before me, and carry what I have learned so that I may teach it. Let your Light go with me.

Janus and Hestia, the Door and the Flame: I thank you for keeping this Dwelling.

Metatron and Sandalphon, Holder of the Seat and Carrier of the Ascent: I thank you for guiding my Hands.

Uriel and Raziel, Instructor and Translator, Guardians of Daath: I thank you for opening my Ears.

Gabriel and Idris, Holder of Images and Scribe of the Seat: I thank you for clearing my Eyes.

Seshat and Iris, Founder and Oath-bearer: I thank you for keeping and carrying my Word.

Rosmerta and the Charites, the Given and the Passed On: I thank you for my Delight.

Hermanubis and Ma'at, Guide of the Descent and Feather of Truth: I thank you for keeping my Heart light.

Thermes and Aphael, the Word that Makes and the Word that is True: I thank you for my Craft.

Aphael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: I thank you for weighing my Weight truly.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Crossing, the Guide of the Descent, and the Hinge on which the Door turns: I thank you for carrying my Voice,

and for bringing me back across every crossing.

Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: I leave here my gratitude and my joy, and take my Will and Intent out into the world.

By my Birthright, I close this Book and cross back over the threshold.

Word into deed.

The Door is closed.